

Chapter 40-1: Transferring Energy

A bolt of heavenly thunder followed, lightning piercing into her heart and lungs like steel needles penetrating her entire body. Ning Fuyi's vision went black, and sweetness surged in her throat.

"Ning Fuyi..." Chu Qingqiu's voice rang beside her ear, extremely weak.

Ning Fuyi held her even tighter, until that soft body was almost completely buried in her embrace.

"Living and dying together," the man laughed again with his cackling sound, laughing as if he couldn't catch his breath. "Chu Ling Divine Venerable, you really are quite likeable. Both the older and younger ones care about you so much—how touching indeed."

"You, what nonsense are you spouting!" Chu Qingqiu said in great anger. She wanted to push Ning Fuyi away, but had no strength left.

"Tsk, ts, ts. The once infinitely glorious Chu Ling Divine Venerable is now nothing more than my defeated opponent. I really want those who fawn over you to see what a pitiful state you're in now," the man sighed, slowly raising his right hand. Boundless lightning gathered into the Emei Thorn, emitting blinding light.

He didn't take Ning Fuyi seriously at all, so he also didn't notice the increasingly intense ruthlessness in the young woman's eyes.

"Shut up," Ning Fuyi suddenly said, her voice low and sinister.

"Can't bear to hear it?" the man sneered, the lightning in his hand growing ever more intense. He didn't stop his humiliation either. "Chu Ling Divine Venerable certainly raised a good little brat, just as overconfident as you..."

"I told you to shut up!" Ning Fuyi said through gritted teeth. Tremendous fury burned in her heart and lungs. She poured all her strength into her right hand, then raised the sword in her grasp and thrust it desperately toward the man.

"No, Ning Fuyi!" Ning Fuyi had never heard Chu Qingqiu make such a heart-rending sound. She could only see the man's hideous face opposite her. The man laughed dismissively, and the Emei Thorn spun into sheets, carrying thunder as it struck toward her vital points.

The unremarkable stone sword in her hand suddenly collided with the Emei Thorn. In that instant, she saw the man's mouth suddenly tense.

In the thick black smoke, a radiance suddenly burst forth from the sword tip—different from all the firelight and lightning around them, that radiance was warm and gentle, tinged with a faint pink, slowly spreading in all directions.

Then, it was as if ancient songs were ringing in her ears. Tremendous pink power coursed through the sword body, sweeping across the entire Divine Meteorite.

For a moment, the entire Divine Meteorite shook and trembled. Countless fragments of stone bearing murals fell from the sky. Ning Fuyi stared in shock at the sword hilt in her hand, unable to believe her eyes.

The dark Divine Meteorite was illuminated by the radiance. The originally thick black smoke had long been dispersed. The young woman in fluttering black clothes stood in such brilliance, her hair cascading down—for a moment, one couldn't tell whether she was immortal or demon.

"No, no, no!" The man's furious howling echoed among the ruins, soon drowned out by collapsing towers. Countless massive stones fell together with surging air currents, as if to bury everything here.

The sword continuously drew upon Ning Fuyi's strength. Her vision gradually dimmed, and the clamor in her ears seemed muffled by a barrier, no longer so intense.

At the moment the light before her eyes disappeared, Ning Fuyi instinctively held tight the unconscious body in her embrace, then fell.

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Ning Fuyi was again awakened by the sound of water. This time the water drops didn't fall beside her ear, but struck her face directly, covering her with cold moisture.

She opened her eyes to face the void above, her mind foggy.

"Chu Qingqiu?" she called out softly. However, the surroundings were deathly silent, with no one responding to her. Ning Fuyi's heart immediately sank. She sat up abruptly, accidentally bumping her arm and frowning from the pain.

What had just happened? She had thought she would die at that man's hands, but that sword...

That sword? Ning Fuyi immediately held her breath, reaching out to feel around in the pile of rubble. But before she could search for it, a smooth, cold sword hilt actively fell into her hand.

The sudden contact in the darkness nearly made her throw the sword away, but she quickly calmed down, slowly grasping the sword and raising it before her eyes.

The sword body suddenly emitted a lustrous light, illuminating the small area around her.

Ning Fuyi stared intently at the originally dull, unremarkable sword in her hand, shocked to discover that as it emitted its glow, the entire sword had transformed as if shedding its skin, revealing an ice-crystal-like interior.

Where had she picked up this sword? It seemed she had just grabbed it randomly. Earlier, when she had resolved to die, she hadn't cared what she took.

Now, thinking back, the position where she had been standing seemed to be...

The divine sword that Chu Qingqiu had mentioned!

She couldn't help but part her lips slightly. This matter was too shocking for her. Someone who could only cultivate demon arts in her previous life had somehow easily drawn a divine sword in this lifetime—it was simply fantastical.

But the facts were right before her. This sword obediently nestled its hilt in her palm. Ning Fuyi only needed to think, and it would brighten or dim according to her thoughts.

However, there were still urgent matters at hand. Ning Fuyi quickly pulled herself from her shock and, borrowing the light emitted by the sword body, stood up to search for Chu Qingqiu among the ruins of the Divine Meteorite.

Finding Chu Qingqiu wasn't difficult—she only needed to follow the scent of blood. Ning Fuyi soon discovered her lying half-prostrate on a section of steps, her body curled up, motionless.

"Chu Qingqiu!" Ning Fuyi called out urgently, running to her side in a few steps. She pulled Chu Qingqiu into her arms with one hand and hurriedly checked her breathing.

Weak, but there was still airflow.

Ning Fuyi's tense heart finally relaxed somewhat. She waved her hand to summon immortal energy¹, pouring it into Chu Qingqiu's chest to slowly heal her injuries.

Whether it was her imagination or not, the immortal energy she output seemed to carry a hint of pink, and after that recent battle, her power had not only not been depleted but had become much more abundant.

Footnotes:

¹ **Immortal energy (仙力)** - The spiritual power used by cultivators, distinct from demonic energy. It's considered pure and divine in nature.